

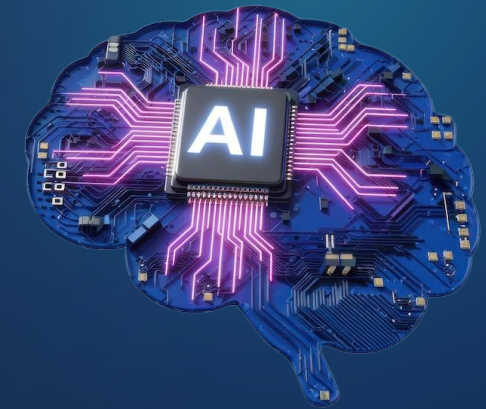
TWO-DAY CORPORATE TRAINING PROGRAMME

AI for **Modern Work**

Boosting Productivity with Microsoft Copilot & ChatGPT

21–22 September 2026

Facilitated by Fakhru Syahmi
Mufasyah Consultant



Designed for MNC, government and
education-sector teams.

YOUR FACILITATOR

Fakhrul Syahmi — Data Science & Analytics Consultant



This programme is built from practitioner experience: what actually saves time at work, what needs verification, and what should never be pasted into a public tool.

FOCUS

Data analysis, business reporting and practical AI adoption for working teams.

SECTORS

Multinational corporates, government agencies and education institutions.

APPROACH

Hands-on and scenario-led — every concept is tied to a task you already do.

YOUR PART

Bring a real task from your own role. We will work on it during the activities.

TRAINING OBJECTIVES

By the end of the programme, you will be able to

01 **Explain generative AI in plain language**

Describe what these tools do, where they help and where they fail — without technical jargon.

02 **Position Copilot and ChatGPT correctly**

Choose the right tool for the task, within your organisation's policy.

03 **Write prompts that produce usable output**

Apply a repeatable six-part prompt structure instead of guessing.

04 **Apply AI across Microsoft 365**

Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and Teams — with realistic expectations.

05 **Turn data into management insight**

Move from raw figures to a question, an analysis and a recommended action.

06 **Work safely and responsibly**

Protect confidential data, verify output and keep human judgement in the loop.

WHAT PARTICIPANTS WILL LEARN

Three capabilities, developed over two days

Each day moves from understanding, to technique, to application in your own role.

Understand

- What generative AI is — and is not
- How large language models actually behave
- Why output quality depends on your input
- Where hallucination comes from
- What licensing and configuration affect

Operate

- The six-part prompt framework
- Weak → better → strong prompt progression
- Advanced techniques: few-shot, iterative, critique
- Copilot inside Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams
- ChatGPT for analysis, research and drafting

Apply & govern

- Department-level use cases
- A reusable personal prompt library
- A 10-step working method
- Data classification before you paste
- Verification and human sign-off

PROGRAMME STRUCTURE

The 2-day training journey

Session	Day 1 — 21 September	Day 2 — 22 September
09:00 – 10:30	Opening · Generative AI for modern work	Day 1 recap · AI with PowerPoint
10:45 – 12:30	Microsoft Copilot · ChatGPT · Comparison	AI with Outlook and Microsoft Teams
13:30 – 15:00	Prompt engineering framework · Weak vs strong prompts	ChatGPT for business · AI for data analysis
15:15 – 17:00	Advanced prompting · Email · Word · Excel	Meetings · Research · Responsible AI · Use cases
Close	Recap · Reflection · Mini challenge	Prompt library · Workflow · Personal action plan

Hands-on activities are distributed across both days — eight in total.

HOW TO PARTICIPATE

Ground rules for a working session

This is a workshop, not a webinar. The value comes from the tasks you bring.

Expected of you

- Bring a real, non-confidential work task
- Try every activity — attempts beat notes
- Ask when something does not match your setup
- Share what worked with your table

Expected of me

- Plain language, no unnecessary jargon
- Realistic capability claims only
- Flag where licence or admin settings apply
- Practical examples from actual work

Non-negotiable

- No confidential or personal data in any tool today
- Use your organisation's approved platforms
- Verify anything you intend to send or publish
- Follow your own internal AI policy first

OPENING DISCUSSION

How are you currently using AI at work?

Which tools are already approved and available in your organisation?

What is the one task you would hand over tomorrow if you could?

What has stopped you from using these tools so far?

01

Generative AI for Modern Work

- Definitions that matter
- How LLMs behave
- Strengths and limits
- Hallucination
- Human judgement

What these tools are, how they behave, and where professional judgement still decides the outcome.

FOUNDATIONS

What is artificial intelligence?

Software that performs tasks we normally associate with human reasoning — recognising patterns, interpreting language, making predictions.

At work, AI is not a single product. It is a capability now embedded inside tools you already pay for: search, spam filtering, translation, forecasting, and now drafting and summarising.

WHY IT MATTERS AT WORK

It changes how long routine knowledge work takes, not what your job is.

EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Outlook deciding which messages are junk, or Excel suggesting a chart type.

THE RISK

Assuming the system understands your business context. It does not, unless you supply it.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Identify the repeatable, language-heavy parts of your week — those are the candidates.

FOUNDATIONS

What is machine learning?

A system that learns patterns from large amounts of past data, rather than following rules a developer wrote by hand.

Traditional software is instructed. Machine learning is trained. That difference explains both the flexibility and the unpredictability you will see today.

WHY IT MATTERS AT WORK

Output is probabilistic, not guaranteed — the same prompt can give different answers.

EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

A demand forecast that improves as more sales history is added.

THE RISK

Patterns learned from past data carry the biases and gaps of that data.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Treat outputs as a first draft to be checked, never as a system of record.

FOUNDATIONS

What is generative AI?

A system that produces new content — text, tables, summaries, code, images — in response to an instruction written in ordinary language.

This is the shift that matters for office work: the interface is now a sentence, so the quality of your sentence determines the quality of the result.

WHY IT MATTERS AT WORK

Drafting, summarising and restructuring move from hours to minutes.

EVERYDAY EXAMPLE

Turning a 40-page report into a five-point brief for a steering committee.

THE RISK

Fluent writing is not the same as correct content.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Use it where a draft is the bottleneck, then apply your own expertise.

APPLICATION

Where generative AI earns its place in the working week

The pattern is consistent: language-heavy, repeatable, and reviewable by a human.

01 **Drafting**

Emails, proposals, SOPs, announcements and briefing notes — from blank page to working draft.

02 **Summarising**

Long reports, meeting transcripts and email threads compressed to decisions and actions.

03 **Restructuring**

The same content rewritten for a different audience, length or tone.

04 **Explaining**

Formulas, contracts, technical documents and policies translated into plain language.

05 **Exploring**

Twenty options generated in two minutes, so you can choose rather than invent.

06 **Analysing**

Patterns, variances and outliers surfaced from a dataset you then verify.

HOW IT WORKS

Large language models, in simple terms

No memory of your company, no database lookup — a prediction engine working one word at a time.

Trained on text at scale

The model learns statistical relationships between words from a very large body of text.



You provide a prompt

Your instruction plus any context you paste in becomes the model's entire working brief.



It predicts the next word

Repeatedly, at speed — producing language that fits the pattern of your request.



You receive fluent output

Confident, well-formed text that may or may not be factually correct.

Practical consequence: the model optimises for plausible language, not verified truth. Verification stays with you.

THE SHIFT

From traditional software to generative AI

Each stage did not replace the one before it. They now operate side by side in the same workflow.



Where you sit today: most organisations run all four at once. The skill is knowing which layer a task belongs to.

COMPARISON

Traditional automation and generative AI solve different problems

TRADITIONAL AUTOMATION

Deterministic and repeatable

- Same input always produces the same output
- Rules must be defined in advance
- Breaks when the input format changes
- Ideal for high-volume, unchanging processes
- Example: an invoice posted automatically each month

GENERATIVE AI

Flexible and probabilistic

- Output varies between runs on the same prompt
- Handles unstructured, messy input well
- Adapts to a request phrased in plain language
- Ideal for one-off, judgement-based knowledge work
- Example: summarising fifty supplier emails into three themes

CAPABILITY

What AI is genuinely good at

These are the tasks where a first draft from AI beats a blank page from you.

Language work

- Drafting and rewriting
- Adjusting tone and register
- Shortening or expanding
- Translation for internal use
- Grammar and clarity

Structure work

- Summarising long documents
- Extracting actions and decisions
- Converting prose into tables
- Building outlines and agendas
- Standardising formats

Thinking support

- Generating many options quickly
- Stress-testing an argument
- Explaining unfamiliar material
- Suggesting what you may have missed
- Drafting first-pass analysis

LIMITS

What AI is not good at

Knowing the failure modes is what separates confident use from risky use.

Factual reliability

- Citing sources it cannot access
- Recent events outside its data
- Precise figures it was not given
- Legal, medical or regulatory certainty
- Anything requiring an audit trail

Organisational context

- Your internal policies, unless supplied
- Unwritten history behind a decision
- Politics and stakeholder sensitivities
- Data it has no permission to see
- Your commercial constraints

Accountability

- Owning a decision or its consequences
- Professional or ethical judgement
- Weighing trade-offs with real stakes
- Signing off on what is sent
- Being answerable to a regulator

HALLUCINATION

AI can state something entirely incorrect with complete confidence.

A hallucination is output that is fluent, plausible and wrong. It happens because the model predicts likely language rather than retrieving verified facts. It is most common with specific figures, names, citations, legal clauses and anything recent. The tone gives you no warning — which is exactly why verification cannot be optional.

Four habits that keep fabricated output out of your work

1

Supply the source

Paste or attach the document. Output grounded in your material is far less likely to be invented.

2

Ask for the basis

Request that the model state which part of the supplied material each claim comes from.

3

Check every number

Figures, dates, names, percentages and citations are verified against the original, always.

4

Distrust confidence

Assertive phrasing is a writing style, not evidence. Treat it as a claim to be tested.

HUMAN JUDGEMENT

AI is an assistant. You remain the professional who is accountable.

The model can produce the draft, the summary and the first-pass analysis. It cannot weigh commercial risk, read the room, or answer for the decision afterwards. Everything that leaves your desk carries your name — not the tool's. Use AI to remove the mechanical work so that more of your time goes to the judgement only you can supply.

02

Microsoft Copilot

The ecosystem
Microsoft Graph
Grounding
Licence dependencies

AI positioned inside the applications where your work already lives — and grounded in your organisation's own content.

ORIENTATION

What is Microsoft Copilot?

Microsoft's generative AI assistant, surfaced across Microsoft 365 applications and grounded — where licensed — in your organisation's own data.

The distinguishing feature is not the model. It is the context: Copilot can work with documents, emails and meetings you already have permission to access.

WHERE YOU MEET IT

Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, and a standalone chat experience.

WHAT MAKES IT DIFFERENT

Access to your tenant content, subject to your existing permissions.

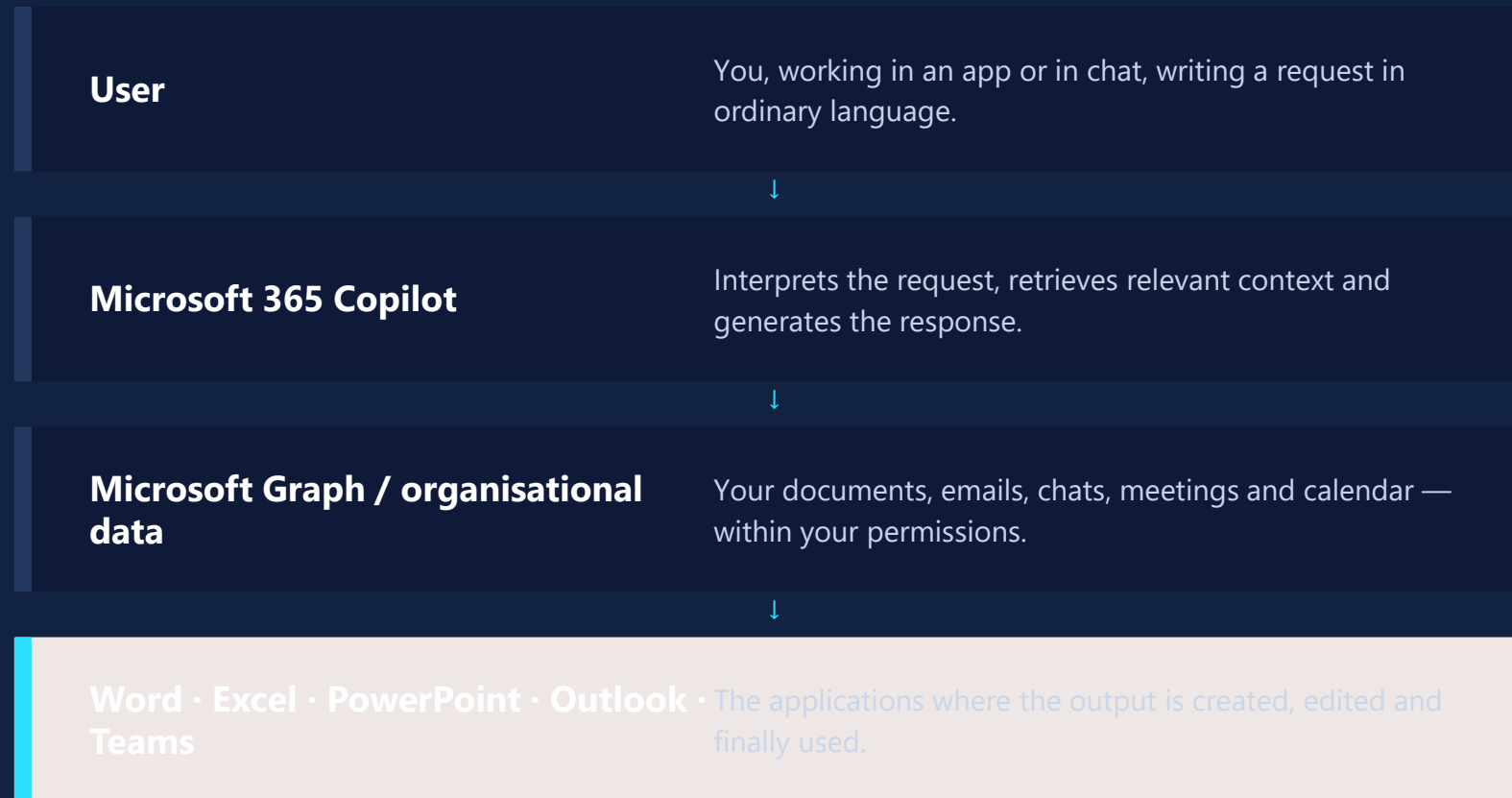
WHAT IT RESPECTS

Your existing access rights — it does not expose content you could not already open.

IMPORTANT CAVEAT

Available features depend on licence, tenant configuration and app version.

The Microsoft Copilot ecosystem



Availability of each layer depends on your licence and your administrator's configuration.

Microsoft 365 Copilot and Copilot Chat

Two different experiences, frequently confused. What you have depends on what your organisation has licensed.

Microsoft 365 Copilot

- Embedded in the Office applications
- Can reference your organisational content
- Works on the file or meeting in front of you
- Requires the relevant paid licence
- Governed by your tenant's settings

Copilot Chat

- A conversational, chat-first experience
- General assistance and web-grounded answers
- Broader availability across the organisation
- Capability set differs from the embedded version
- Check what your tenant has enabled

Practical implication

- Confirm which you have before planning a workflow
- Features shown in public demos may not be enabled
- Rollout differs by region and channel
- Admin settings can restrict behaviour
- Ask your IT team, not the internet

INTEGRATION

How Copilot connects with Microsoft 365

The value is proximity — the assistant is already where the document, thread or meeting is.

01 **Word**

Draft, rewrite, summarise and query the document currently open.

02 **Excel**

Explore a dataset, suggest formulas and surface patterns within the workbook.

03 **PowerPoint**

Build a first-draft deck, restructure it or generate speaker notes.

04 **Outlook**

Summarise a long thread, draft a reply and adjust the tone before sending.

05 **Teams**

Recap a meeting, list decisions and pull out action items from the discussion.

06 **Chat**

Ask across your content — 'what changed in the proposal since last week?'

KEY CONCEPT

Microsoft Graph, in simple language

Microsoft Graph is the connection layer that lets Copilot see the work content you already have permission to access.

It is not a new data store and it does not widen your access. Think of it as the index that answers: which of this person's files, messages and meetings are relevant to what they just asked?

WHAT IT INCLUDES

Documents, emails, chats, meetings and calendar items within your tenant.

PERMISSIONS

Your existing access rights apply unchanged — Copilot inherits them, it does not bypass them.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is what allows an answer to reference last Tuesday's meeting rather than the open internet.

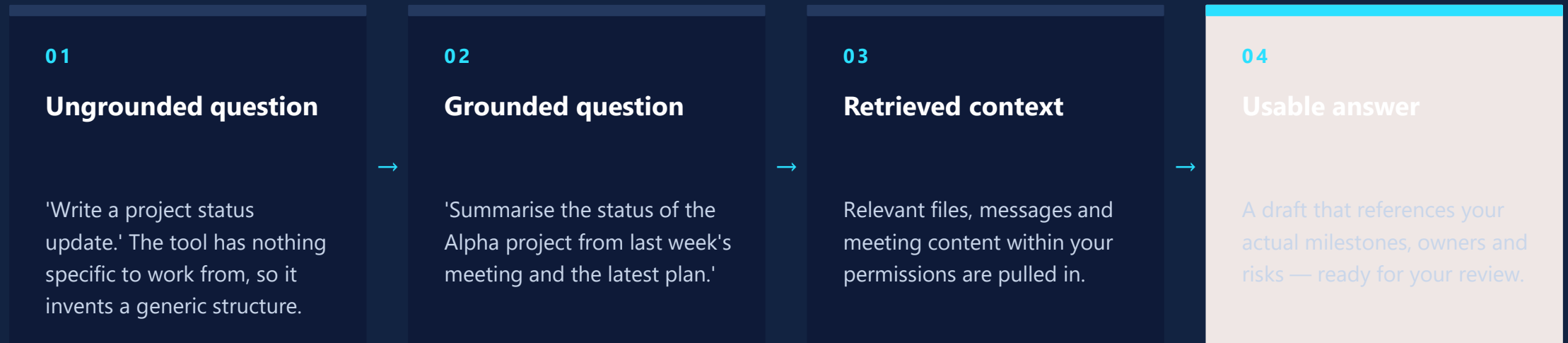
YOUR RESPONSIBILITY

Poorly governed file permissions become poorly governed AI answers. Housekeeping matters.

GROUNDING

Why organisational context changes the answer

The same question produces a very different result depending on what the assistant can see.



Grounding is why an enterprise assistant can be useful for internal work that a general tool cannot reach.

VALUE CASE

Where Copilot pays back time in the daily routine

01 **The overnight inbox**

Summarise a 40-message thread into the decision, the open question and who owes what.

02 **The meeting you missed**

Recap a recorded Teams meeting and extract the action items assigned to your team.

03 **The document nobody read**

Ask a 60-page report direct questions instead of scanning it for an hour.

04 **The recurring report**

Draft the narrative around numbers you have already validated.

05 **The unfamiliar workbook**

Have a formula explained in plain language before you change anything.

06 **The deck due tomorrow**

Turn an approved document into a structured first-draft presentation.

SET EXPECTATIONS CORRECTLY

What you can do depends on four things

Capability claims in public material do not automatically apply to your environment.

1

Licence

Different Copilot offerings carry different capabilities. Confirm what your organisation has purchased.

2

Organisational configuration

Your tenant setup determines which content and services the assistant can reach.

3

Admin settings

Administrators can enable, restrict or stage features across groups and regions.

4

Application version

Features arrive on different schedules by platform, update channel and region.

03

ChatGPT

Core capabilities
Realistic expectations
Business application

A general-purpose reasoning and drafting assistant — strongest where the work is open-ended rather than embedded in your files.

ORIENTATION

What is ChatGPT?

A conversational AI assistant built on a large language model, used through a chat interface rather than inside your Office applications.

It does not have access to your organisation's files, inbox or meetings unless you deliberately provide that material — which is exactly where your data-handling policy applies.

STRENGTH

Open-ended reasoning, ideation and drafting across almost any subject.

WORKING STYLE

Conversational and iterative — you refine the answer through follow-up.

BOUNDARY

No visibility of your internal systems; capability varies by plan and version.

GOVERNANCE

Enterprise and consumer versions differ significantly in data handling. Know which you are using.

CAPABILITY MAP

What can ChatGPT help you do?

Four categories cover nearly every legitimate business use. Start by identifying which one your task belongs to.

Produce

- Draft documents and correspondence
- Rewrite for a different audience
- Build structures, outlines and templates
- Prepare presentation narratives
- Standardise recurring formats

Interrogate

- Analyse a document you supply
- Explore a dataset you paste or upload
- Explain unfamiliar technical material
- Compare two versions or positions
- Extract findings from long text

Think

- Brainstorm options at volume
- Stress-test a plan or argument
- Consider multiple stakeholder views
- Identify risks you may have missed
- Frame a decision and its trade-offs

Review

- Critique your own draft
- Identify gaps and weak reasoning
- Check structure and logical flow
- Suggest sharper phrasing
- Ask what context is missing

Core capabilities in practical terms

01 **Writing**

Proposals, SOPs, announcements and executive summaries — drafted in your specified tone.

02 **Research support**

Explore a topic and structure the questions. Sources still require independent verification.

03 **File analysis**

Summarise, compare and query a document you upload — subject to your data policy.

04 **Data analysis**

Examine a supplied dataset, identify patterns and draft the management narrative.

05 **Brainstorming**

Generate twenty positioning angles or campaign concepts in a single pass.

06 **Problem solving**

Break an ambiguous problem into components, options and decision criteria.

07 **Presentation preparation**

Convert an approved report into a storyline with a clear recommendation.

08 **Document review**

Identify inconsistencies, gaps and unclear passages before circulation.

REALISTIC EXPECTATIONS

Describing ChatGPT accurately to your colleagues

Overstating capability is the fastest route to a failed AI rollout.

BEFORE

Common overstatement

"It knows everything and can replace research."

"It can access our SharePoint and systems."

"If it sounds confident, it is correct."

"It remembers our company context automatically."

"We can paste anything into it."

AFTER

Accurate description

It reasons over language extremely well; facts require verification.

It sees only what you deliberately give it in the conversation.

Confidence is a writing style, not evidence of accuracy.

Context must be supplied by you, every time, unless configured otherwise.

Data handling depends on the plan — and on your organisation's policy.

04

Microsoft Copilot vs ChatGPT

Side-by-side comparison
Scenario routing
Policy first

Not a contest. Two tools with different centres of gravity — and a simple rule for choosing between them.

COMPARISON — PART 1

Where each tool is naturally stronger

Dimension	Microsoft Copilot	ChatGPT
Primary purpose	Productivity inside the Microsoft 365 applications you already use	General-purpose reasoning, drafting and exploration
Microsoft 365 integration	Native — it sits inside Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams	External to your Office environment
Organisational data	Can reference tenant content within your existing permissions	Only what you deliberately supply in the conversation
General reasoning	Capable, with an enterprise-work orientation	A core strength — open-ended and flexible
Research	Useful for internal content; web grounding depends on configuration	Strong for topic exploration; sources still need verification

Both tools evolve rapidly. Confirm current capability against your own licence and configuration.

COMPARISON — PART 2

Applied to the work you actually do

Dimension	Microsoft Copilot	ChatGPT
Writing	Strong where the document, thread or file is already open	Strong for open drafting, tone range and restructuring
Data analysis	Works with the workbook in front of you, within Excel	Works with data you upload or paste; flexible analysis framing
File analysis	Files within your tenant, subject to permissions	Files you upload — check your data policy first
Presentations	Can draft within PowerPoint from your own content	Strong at structuring the storyline and narrative
Collaboration	Meeting recaps, threads and shared organisational context	Individual working sessions
Enterprise environment	Designed for tenant governance and admin control	Governance depends on plan — enterprise and consumer differ

SCENARIO ROUTING

Which tool should I use?

Ask one question first: does this task depend on our internal content?

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Summarise an internal Teams meeting your team held yesterday

AI APPROACH

Microsoft 365 Copilot — the meeting content sits inside your tenant

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Recap this meeting, list the decisions taken and the action items with owners."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured recap referencing the actual discussion, ready for circulation

HUMAN VALIDATION

Confirm the decisions and owners with attendees before sending the minutes

SCENARIO ROUTING

Four situations, four sensible choices

Situation	Suggested tool	Why
Summarise an internal Teams meeting	Microsoft 365 Copilot	The content lives in your tenant and requires permission-aware access
Brainstorm 20 campaign ideas	ChatGPT may be suitable	Open-ended ideation with no dependency on internal data
Analyse an Excel workbook inside Microsoft 365	Microsoft Copilot	Works with the workbook in place, inside your governed environment
Critique a business strategy from several perspectives	ChatGPT	Multi-perspective reasoning on material you choose to share

In every case, your organisation's AI and data policy takes precedence over the suggestion above.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Organisational policy decides the tool. Capability only decides the technique.

A tool being technically capable does not make it approved. Before routing any task, confirm which platforms your organisation permits, what classification of information may be used with each, and who to ask when the answer is unclear. If the policy and the demonstration disagree, follow the policy.

05

Prompt Engineering

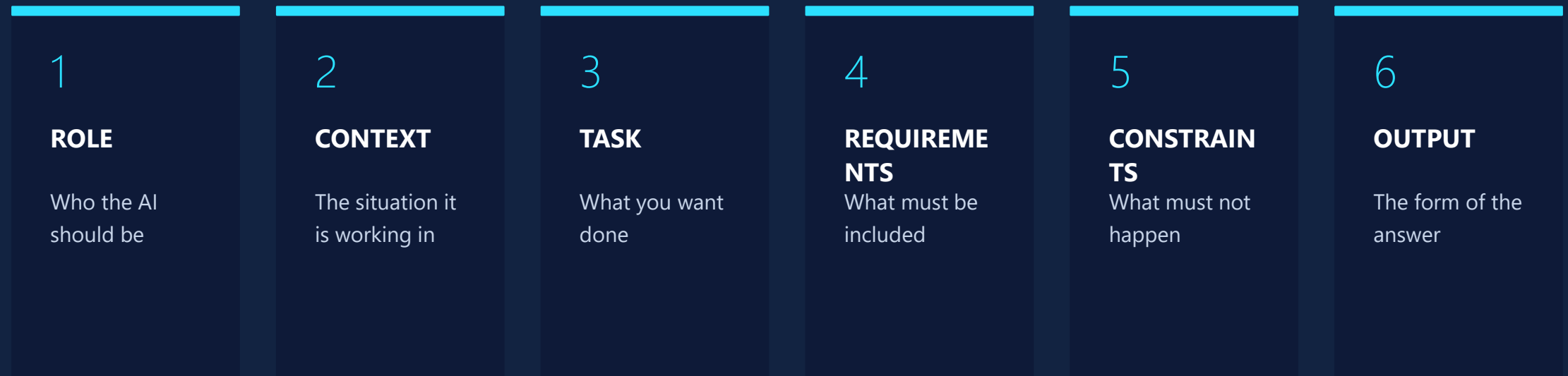
The six-part framework
Component by component
A full worked example

The single highest-return skill in this programme. A structured request consistently outperforms a clever one.

THE FRAMEWORK

ROLE + CONTEXT + TASK + REQUIREMENTS + CONSTRAINTS + OUTPUT

Six components. Not every prompt needs all six — but the important ones usually do.



ROLE — set the expertise and perspective

Naming a role shifts the vocabulary, depth and priorities of the response before the task is even read.

A financial analyst, an HR business partner and a marketing lead will each read the same numbers differently. Tell the model which one you need.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Act as a senior financial analyst reporting to a board audit committee."

COMMON FAILURE

Leaving it blank produces a generic, mid-level tone suited to nobody in particular.

CONTEXT — supply the situation

Context is the single biggest lever on output quality. The model knows nothing about your organisation unless you tell it.

Include the business situation, what has already happened, who the audience is and why the task matters now.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Our company experienced a decline in Q2 revenue, concentrated in the northern region, following a competitor's price reduction."

COMMON FAILURE

Without context you get textbook advice that could apply to any company on earth.

TASK — state one clear instruction

A precise verb and a single objective. Ambiguity here produces output that misses the point entirely.

If you need three things done, consider three prompts — or number them explicitly within one.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Analyse the following monthly sales data and explain the decline."

COMMON FAILURE

Vague verbs such as 'look at', 'help with' or 'do something with' produce vague results.

REQUIREMENTS — define what must be included

Requirements convert a general answer into a usable deliverable that meets your actual standard.

State quantity, coverage and the specific elements that must appear, so nothing essential is left out.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Identify the top three drivers, quantify each in ringgit and percentage terms, and recommend one action per driver."

COMMON FAILURE

Omitting requirements means you review the draft and send it back three times.

CONSTRAINTS — define the boundaries

Constraints prevent the two most common problems:
invented facts and inappropriate length.

This is also where you control scope, tone and the treatment of anything
uncertain.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Use only the data provided. Do not estimate missing figures.
Keep the response under 300 words."

COMMON FAILURE

Without constraints the model fills gaps with plausible
invention — the root of most hallucination at work.

OUTPUT FORMAT — specify the shape of the answer

Specifying the format removes almost all reformatting work and makes the output immediately usable.

Tables, numbered lists, executive summaries, email drafts, slide outlines — name the container you need.

EXAMPLE PHRASING

"Present the result as an executive table with columns for Driver, Impact, Evidence and Recommended Action."

COMMON FAILURE

Unspecified format defaults to long prose paragraphs — the least useful form for business review.

WORKED EXAMPLE

The six components assembled into one prompt

This is what a professional prompt looks like in practice.

ROLE + CONTEXT

"Act as a senior financial analyst reporting to our board audit committee. Our company experienced a decline in Q2 revenue, concentrated in the northern region, following a competitor price reduction in April."

TASK + REQUIREMENTS

"Analyse the monthly sales data below. Identify the top three drivers of the decline, quantify each in both value and percentage terms, and recommend one specific action per driver."

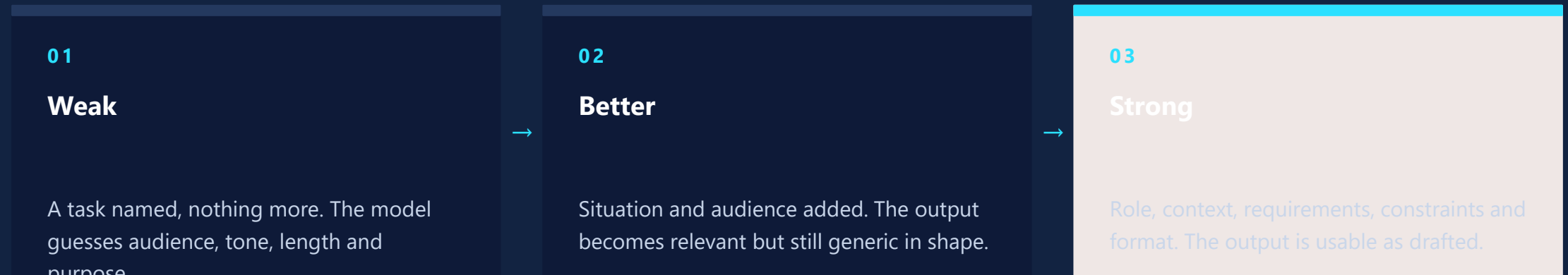
CONSTRAINTS + OUTPUT FORMAT

"Use only the data provided and do not estimate missing figures; flag any gap explicitly. Keep it under 300 words and present it as an executive table with columns for Driver, Impact, Evidence and Recommended Action."

THE PROGRESSION

Every strong prompt is a weak prompt that was developed

The difference is not vocabulary. It is the amount of specification you supply.



Time cost of the strong version: roughly ninety seconds. Time saved in rework: considerably more.

EXAMPLE — EMAIL

Drafting a client follow-up

WEAK

No audience, no situation, no tone

"Write an email."

BETTER

Situation and purpose added

"Write a professional follow-up email to a client who has not responded to our proposal after seven days."

STRONG

Role, context, constraints and intent

"You are an account manager. Write a concise and polite follow-up email to a corporate client who received our training proposal seven days ago but has not responded. Avoid sounding pushy. Ask whether they require clarification and include a gentle call to action."

EXAMPLE — REPORT

Producing a management report section

WEAK

No subject, scope or reader

"Write a report."

BETTER

Subject and period defined

"Write a quarterly operations report summarising our Q3 performance."

STRONG

Full specification, grounded in supplied data

"You are an operations manager writing for a senior leadership committee. Using only the Q3 performance data below, write the executive section of the quarterly report: state overall performance against target, explain the two largest variances with evidence, identify one emerging risk, and close with three recommended actions. Maximum 400 words, in formal business English, structured with subheadings."

EXAMPLE — MEETINGS

Preparing and closing a meeting

WEAK

No purpose or participants

"Help me with my meeting."

BETTER

Meeting type and objective stated

"Create an agenda for a one-hour project review meeting with our vendor."

STRONG

Role, attendees, timing and deliverable

"You are a project manager. Create an agenda for a 60-minute project review with our implementation vendor and two internal department heads. The project is four weeks behind schedule. Allocate time to each item, include three difficult questions we should ask the vendor, and finish with a decision point on the revised timeline. Present it as a table with Time, Item, Owner and Intended Outcome."

EXAMPLE — DATA ANALYSIS

Asking for analysis of a dataset

WEAK

No question, no direction

"Analyse my data."

BETTER

Measure and period specified

"Analyse monthly revenue for the past twelve months and tell me the trend."

STRONG

Comparison, thresholds and management framing

"Analyse monthly revenue from January to December against target. Identify the three largest negative variances, quantify each in value and percentage, highlight any month where the pattern breaks from the preceding trend, and state three questions management should investigate. Use only the supplied figures and present the result as a table followed by a five-line summary."

EXAMPLE — POWERPOINT

Turning content into a presentation

WEAK

No audience, length or message

"Make a presentation about our project."

BETTER

Audience and length defined

"Create a 10-slide presentation for senior management about our project status."

STRONG

Narrative structure and per-slide brief

"You are preparing a 10-minute update for the executive committee. Using the project report below, produce a 10-slide outline following Situation, Insight, Implication, Recommendation, Action. For each slide give a one-sentence takeaway title, three supporting points of no more than eight words each, and a note on the visual to use. Lead with the decision required, not the background."

EXAMPLE — RESEARCH

Exploring an unfamiliar topic

WEAK

Unbounded and unverifiable

"Tell me about AI regulation."

BETTER

Scope and relevance narrowed

"Summarise the main AI regulatory themes that affect companies operating in Southeast Asia."

STRONG

Structured, bounded and honest about uncertainty

"You are briefing a compliance committee. Summarise the main regulatory themes affecting AI use by companies operating in Southeast Asia. For each theme, state the practical obligation, the likely operational impact on a mid-sized firm, and what remains uncertain. Clearly separate well-established points from areas where you are unsure, and list the questions our legal team should verify independently. Maximum one page."

ACTIVITY 1

Improve the prompt

TIME

15 min

OBJECTIVE

Convert a weak prompt into a strong one using the six-part framework.

SCENARIO

You need to write a message to your department announcing a change to a routine process. Your first attempt at a prompt is simply: "Write an announcement about the new process."

TASK

Working in pairs, rewrite the prompt adding role, context, requirements, constraints and output format. Run both versions and compare the two outputs side by side.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

One rewritten prompt of at least four components, and a one-sentence explanation of which addition improved the output most.

TECHNIQUE

Zero-shot, few-shot and role prompting

Three techniques that change the output without changing the task.

Zero-shot

- You describe the task with no examples
- Fast and adequate for routine requests
- Output follows the model's default style
- Use when the format does not matter much
- Example: 'Summarise this email thread in five points.'

Few-shot

- You supply two or three worked examples first
- The model copies your pattern and tone
- The most reliable way to enforce a house style
- Ideal for recurring, standardised outputs
- Example: three past status updates, then 'now write this week's.'

Role prompting

- You assign an explicit professional perspective
- Shifts vocabulary, depth and what gets prioritised
- Useful for reviewing the same material twice
- Can be stacked: analyst, then sceptical CFO
- Example: 'Review this as a risk manager would.'

Constraint, structure and critique prompting

Constraint prompting

- Bound length, scope and source material
- 'Use only the data provided'
- 'Do not estimate missing values'
- 'Do not exceed 250 words'
- The most effective guard against invention

Structured output

- Name the container you need
- Table with specified column headings
- Numbered list with a fixed count
- Email draft with subject line
- Slide outline with takeaway titles

Critique and revise

- Ask the model to review its own draft
- 'Identify the three weakest points'
- 'Where is this argument unsupported?'
- Then instruct it to rewrite accordingly
- Two passes beat one long prompt

TECHNIQUE

Ask the AI what context it is missing

Before accepting an answer, ask: "What additional information would help you answer this more accurately?"

This single question converts a guessing exercise into a briefing conversation — and frequently reveals the assumption that would have made the output wrong.

WHEN TO USE IT

Any task where the output will inform a real decision.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

A list of gaps: timeframe, audience, constraints, data definitions, success criteria.

WHAT TO DO WITH IT

Supply the two or three items that genuinely matter, then re-run the request.

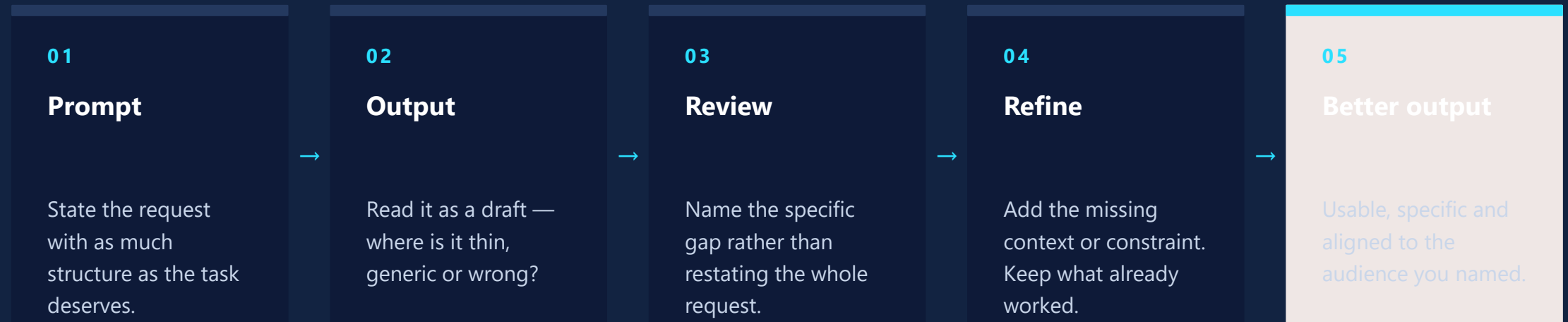
WHY IT WORKS

It surfaces the assumptions the model would otherwise have filled in silently.

ITERATIVE PROMPTING

Your first prompt does not need to be your final prompt

Professionals iterate. The first output is a diagnostic, not a deliverable.



Refinement phrasing that works: 'Keep the structure but make section two more specific and add the figures from the table above.'

06

AI for Email & Communication

Drafting and tone
Before and after
Hands-on rewrite

The highest-frequency use case in almost every organisation — and the easiest place to demonstrate immediate return.

Ten things AI does well in your inbox

Drafting

- First-draft emails from a one-line brief
- Follow-ups on unanswered messages
- Client responses to standard queries
- Internal announcements
- Management updates

Improving

- Raising professionalism of a rushed draft
- Shortening a long message without losing meaning
- Adjusting tone — firmer, warmer, more neutral
- Grammar and clarity correction
- Translation for internal working use

Always yours

- The decision being communicated
- Commercial terms and commitments
- Names, figures and dates
- Whether the tone suits this relationship
- The final send

BEFORE AND AFTER

A rushed internal message, professionally rewritten

Same information, same author, ninety seconds apart.

BEFORE

BEFORE

"Hi all, just letting you know the report is late again because finance didn't send the numbers, so we can't do anything until they do. I've chased them twice already. Will update when I know more. Sorry."

Problems: assigns blame, gives no revised date, no action, no reassurance for the reader who needs to plan.

AFTER

AFTER

"Dear all, the monthly report will be issued on Thursday rather than Tuesday. We are waiting on final figures from Finance, and I have confirmed they will be available Wednesday morning.

No action is required from you in the meantime. I will confirm once the report is circulated, and will flag immediately if the date changes again."

Improvements: states the impact, gives a date, removes blame, tells the reader what to do.

SAMPLE PROMPTS

Prompts that work for everyday correspondence

tone adjustment

"Rewrite this message to be more professional and neutral. Keep it under 120 words, remove any blame, and end with a clear next step and date."

shortening

"Reduce this email to its three essential points. Keep the deadline and the requested action. Write it so the reader can act on it from a mobile screen."

difficult response

"You are a client services manager. Draft a reply to this complaint that acknowledges the delay, explains what we are doing without making excuses, and offers a specific remedy. Firm but courteous, under 180 words."

ACTIVITY 2

Rewrite a client email

TIME

20 min

OBJECTIVE

Use a structured prompt to lift a poor email to a professional standard.

SCENARIO

A colleague has sent this to a client: "Hi, sorry we didn't get back to you. Things have been crazy here. Anyway about your request, we can probably do it but it depends. Let me know what you think. Thanks."

TASK

Write a prompt including role, context, tone constraint and word limit. Produce a rewritten version, then critique the output and refine once. Do not use any real client details.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A sendable email of under 150 words, plus a note on what your refinement prompt changed.

07

Copilot in Microsoft Word

Drafting and summarising
SOPs and proposals
Asking documents questions

Where documents are drafted, condensed and translated for different audiences — inside the file you already have open.

Nine document tasks worth delegating

01 **Drafting a document**

From an outline or a brief to a structured first draft you then edit.

02 **Summarising**

A long report reduced to the points a specific audience needs.

03 **Rewriting content**

The same section restructured for clarity or a different reading level.

04 **Changing tone**

Formal, plain, persuasive or neutral, without rewriting from scratch.

05 **Creating SOPs**

Turning a described process into numbered, auditable steps.

06 **Creating proposals**

A consistent structure applied across every submission.

07 **Executive summaries**

A one-page version framed around decisions, not description.

08 **Extracting information**

Pulling obligations, dates, risks or commitments out of dense text.

09 **Asking questions**

Interrogating the document directly instead of reading it end to end.

SAMPLE PROMPTS

Prompts for working with documents

SUMMARISE FOR LEADERSHIP

"Summarise this report into five key points for senior management. Lead with the decision required, quantify impact where the report provides figures, and do not add anything not stated in the document."

REWRITE FOR A DIFFERENT AUDIENCE

"Rewrite this section for a non-technical audience. Keep every factual detail, remove jargon, and explain any term that must be retained. Maintain the original length."

BUILD AN EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

"Create an executive summary focusing on risks, performance and recommended actions. One page maximum, in three labelled sections, referencing only content contained in this document."

IN PRACTICE

Asking a document direct questions

Microsoft Word — Copilot pane

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

"What are the contractual obligations on our side, and which have deadlines within 60 days?"

WHY THIS BEATS READING

You reach the answer in one step instead of scanning sixty pages for it.

WHAT TO VERIFY

Open every clause it cites. Confirm the wording and the date yourself.

LICENCE NOTE

Availability of the Copilot pane depends on your licence and app version.

08

AI with Microsoft Excel

Understanding data
Formulas explained
Variance and anomalies
From data to insight

The strongest practical module of the programme: moving from figures on a sheet to an insight a manager can act on.

CAPABILITY

What AI can do with a dataset

Assistance, not authority. Every figure that reaches a decision-maker is still verified by you.

Understand

- Describe what each column contains
- Identify the grain of the data
- Flag missing or inconsistent values
- Suggest how to clean it
- Explain an inherited formula

Analyse

- Identify trends over time
- Compare actual against target
- Quantify variances
- Highlight anomalies and outliers
- Segment by region, product or team

Communicate

- Recommend suitable KPIs
- Suggest the right chart for the question
- Draft the management narrative
- Frame the questions to investigate
- Structure the findings for a committee

THE METHOD

From data to insight

Most analysis fails at step two. A dataset without a question produces description, not insight.



APPLIED SCENARIOS

Four datasets, four business questions

Dataset	Business question	What AI contributes
Sales	Why did revenue decline in the northern region during Q2?	Variance by month and product, the three largest contributors, and the questions to investigate
HR	Which factors appear related to employee turnover this year?	Correlation candidates across tenure, department and overtime — framed as hypotheses, not conclusions
Finance	Where are the largest negative budget variances?	Ranked variance table with values and percentages, plus a draft commentary for the review pack
Operations	Which processes are experiencing the longest delays?	Cycle-time comparison by stage, outliers identified, and the bottleneck stated in plain language

Analysis prompts that produce usable answers

REVENUE ANALYSIS

"Analyse monthly sales and identify the top three reasons for declining revenue. Quantify each in value and percentage, use only the data provided, and present the result as a table."

TARGET COMPARISON

"Compare actual sales against target by region. Rank the regions by variance, highlight any region more than 10 per cent below target, and summarise the pattern in three lines."

ANOMALY DETECTION

"Identify unusual changes in employee overtime over the last six months. Flag any department where the month-on-month change exceeds 25 per cent and state what should be checked."

KPI and formula prompts

KPI DEVELOPMENT

"Recommend five KPIs for monitoring inventory performance in a distribution business. For each, state the definition, the data required, and the behaviour it will drive."

FORMULA EXPLANATION

*"Explain this Excel formula in simple language, step by step, and tell me what would break it:
=IFERROR(XLOOKUP(A2,Products!A:A,Products!D:D),"Not found")"*

FORMULA CONSTRUCTION

"Write an XLOOKUP formula that returns the unit price from the Products sheet, matching on product code in column A, and returns "Not found" when there is no match."

DISCIPLINE

Before any AI-assisted number reaches a decision-maker

1

Check the grain

Confirm the tool has interpreted rows, periods and units the way you intended.

2

Re-run the maths

Spot-check totals, percentages and variances independently in the workbook.

3

Test the claim

If it says revenue fell 12 per cent, verify it against the source figures yourself.

4

Own the narrative

You present the conclusion. 'The AI said so' is not an analysis.

ACTIVITY 4

Analyse sales data

TIME

25 min

OBJECTIVE

Move a dataset through the full path from raw figures to a recommended action.

SCENARIO

You are given a twelve-month regional sales extract showing actual against target. Three regions are below plan and one shows an unexplained spike in March.

TASK

Write one analysis prompt using the six-part framework. Produce the variance table, then write the three questions management should investigate. Verify at least two figures manually.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A variance table, a three-line insight statement and one recommended action with a named owner.

DAY 1 RECAP

What we covered today

01 **Generative AI, accurately described**

A prediction engine for language — powerful, fluent and not inherently truthful.

02 **Copilot in its environment**

Grounded in organisational content, subject to licence and configuration.

03 **ChatGPT in its environment**

Open-ended reasoning on material you choose to supply.

04 **Choosing between them**

Start with the data the task depends on, then check policy.

05 **The six-part prompt framework**

Role, context, task, requirements, constraints, output format.

06 **Email, Word and Excel in practice**

Drafting, rewriting, summarising and turning data into insight.

RETAIN THESE

Five lessons from Day 1

1

Context beats cleverness

The best prompt is the one that supplies the most relevant situation.

2

Fluency is not accuracy

Confident phrasing tells you nothing about whether the content is correct.

3

Specify the output

Naming the format removes most of the rework.

4

Iterate deliberately

Name the gap in the draft rather than restating the whole request.

5

You sign it

Accountability does not transfer to the tool.

REFLECTION

Which task in your week would you hand over first — and what would you do with the time?

Choose one recurring task, not a hypothetical one.

Estimate honestly how long it takes you today.

Decide what verification that task would still require.

ACTIVITY 3

Optional overnight challenge — summarise a business report

TIME

20 min, optional

OBJECTIVE

Practise grounded summarisation on material from your own role.

SCENARIO

Select a non-confidential report, policy or industry document of at least five pages that you genuinely need to read.

TASK

Write a prompt that produces a five-point summary for a specific named audience, constrained to the document's own content. Then verify every figure in the summary against the source.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A five-point summary, plus one example of something the tool got wrong, vague or omitted. Bring it to Day 2.

DAY 2 — 22 SEPTEMBER 2026

Day 1 built the method. Day 2 puts it to work.

Yesterday we established what these tools are, how to instruct them and where judgement stays with you. Today we apply that across presentations, meetings, research and data — and set the governance that makes it safe to scale.

DAY 2 AGENDA

Today's programme

Session	Focus	Output you leave with
Morning I	PowerPoint, executive storytelling and Outlook	A storyline structure you can reuse for any update
Morning II	Microsoft Teams and the meeting lifecycle	A before / during / after meeting routine
Afternoon I	ChatGPT for business and AI for data analysis	A seven-stage analysis workflow
Afternoon II	Research, responsible AI and departmental use cases	A data-classification check before you paste
Close	Prompt library, working method and action plan	Your own reusable prompt set and first commitment

QUICK PROMPT CHALLENGE

Five minutes: write the strongest prompt you can for the task on your desk right now.

All six components: role, context, task, requirements, constraints, output.

No confidential detail — describe the situation generically.

Swap with the person next to you and mark the weakest component.

09

AI with PowerPoint

From report to deck
Executive storytelling
Speaker notes

Structure first, slides second. The tool is most useful before you open the deck, not while you are formatting it.

CAPABILITY

Where AI helps in presentation work

01 **Generating ideas**

Angles and framings for a topic before you commit to a structure.

02 **Building the structure**

A logical flow with a stated purpose for every section.

03 **Turning reports into decks**

An approved document converted into a slide-by-slide outline.

04 **Executive storytelling**

Reordering the content so the recommendation leads, not the background.

05 **Speaker notes**

The spoken version of a slide, drafted from your bullet points.

06 **Improving slide wording**

Long bullets reduced to takeaway titles a reader grasps in two seconds.

07 **Summarising technical content**

Specialist material made intelligible to a general executive audience.

08 **Building the narrative**

A one-paragraph through-line that holds the whole deck together.

FRAMEWORK

The executive storytelling structure

SITUATION

What is happening, stated factually and briefly. Where we are today and how we got here.

INSIGHT

What the evidence actually shows — the finding that is not obvious from the raw numbers.

IMPLICATION

Why that finding matters commercially. What happens if nothing changes.

RECOMMENDATION

What you propose should be done, stated as a specific and decidable option.

ACTION

Who does what, by when, and what decision is required from this audience today.

SAMPLE PROMPTS

Prompts for building a presentation

REPORT TO DECK

"Convert this report into a 10-slide outline for an executive committee using Situation, Insight, Implication, Recommendation, Action. Give each slide a full-sentence takeaway title and three supporting points of no more than eight words each."

SHARPEN THE WORDING

"Rewrite these slide bullets so each one states a conclusion rather than a topic. Maximum ten words per bullet. Keep every figure exactly as written."

SPEAKER NOTES

"Write speaker notes for this slide as spoken language for a 90-second delivery. Include one transition sentence into the next slide. Do not introduce any content not on the slide."

ACTIVITY 5

Build an executive presentation

TIME

25 min

OBJECTIVE

Convert a document into a decision-led presentation structure.

SCENARIO

You have a four-page update on a project or initiative in your area. Senior management has ten minutes and needs to approve or reject a next step.

TASK

Prompt for a 10-slide outline using Situation, Insight, Implication, Recommendation, Action. Then refine once so the recommendation appears in the first three slides.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A 10-slide outline with full-sentence takeaway titles and a clearly stated decision request.

10

AI with Outlook

Thread summarisation
Action extraction
Tone control

Managing the volume: threads reduced to decisions, actions extracted, responses drafted in the right register.

Seven tasks across the inbox

Reduce

- Summarise a long thread to decisions and open points
- Identify who is waiting on whom
- Compress a week of correspondence into a brief
- Strip repeated quoted history

Respond

- Draft a reply in a specified tone
- Adjust register for seniority or sensitivity
- Prepare a follow-up on an unanswered message
- Draft a meeting invitation with a clear purpose

Act

- Extract action items with owners and dates
- Identify commitments you have made
- Flag what needs escalation
- Prepare the follow-up before the deadline

WORKED EXAMPLE

A 38-message thread before a supplier review

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A procurement thread has run for three weeks and nobody is certain what was agreed

AI APPROACH

Summarise the thread, then extract decisions and open commitments with owners

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Summarise this thread in under 200 words. Then list every decision taken, every open question, and every commitment with the person responsible and any date mentioned."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A short narrative plus two tables — decisions taken and actions outstanding

HUMAN VALIDATION

Confirm each decision against the original message before treating it as agreed

11

AI with Microsoft Teams

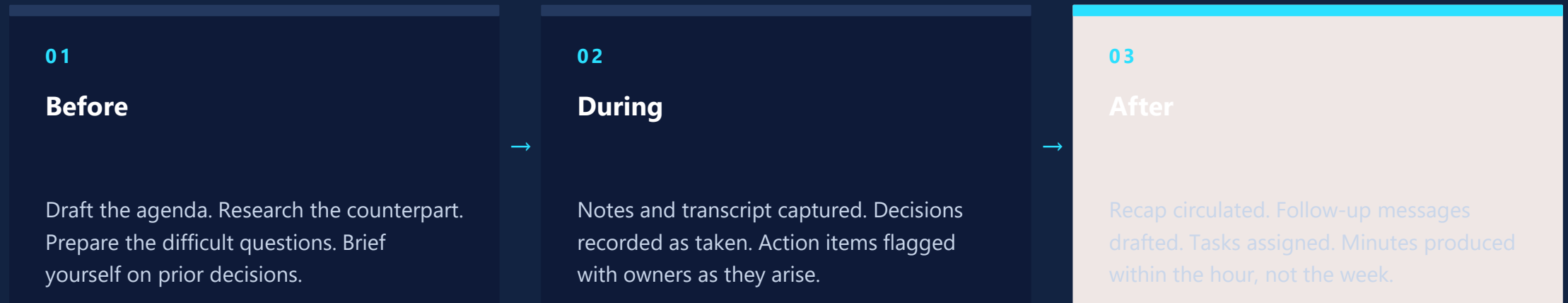
Before, during, after
Recaps and decisions
Action items

Meetings generate more reusable content than any other activity — and capture almost none of it without help.

MEETING LIFECYCLE

Before → During → After

Most organisations use AI only for the recap. The preparation stage is where the meeting is actually won.



Transcription and recap features depend on your licence, meeting policy and whether recording or transcription is enabled by your administrator.

What to ask for at each stage

Before the meeting

- "Draft a 45-minute agenda with time allocations and an outcome per item."
- "Based on these notes, what three questions should I be ready to answer?"
- "Summarise what was agreed in our last two meetings on this topic."

During the meeting

- Let the transcript run where policy permits
- Note decisions explicitly as they are made
- Capture owners and dates verbally so they are recorded
- Confirm actions aloud before closing

After the meeting

- "Recap this meeting in under 200 words for someone who did not attend."
- "List every decision and every action item with owner and due date."
- "Draft the follow-up message to the vendor covering the revised timeline."

ACTIVITY 6

Extract meeting action items

TIME

20 min

OBJECTIVE

Turn an unstructured meeting record into a circulated action list.

SCENARIO

You are given an anonymised transcript extract from a project meeting containing four decisions, several tangents and six implied commitments — none clearly assigned.

TASK

Prompt for a decisions table and an actions table with owner and due date. Identify which commitments are ambiguous and draft the clarifying message.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

Two tables plus one clarification email, and a note on which actions the transcript did not make clear.

12

ChatGPT for Business Productivity

Thinking work
Writing work
Decision support

Where the task is open-ended, exploratory or requires perspectives you do not have in the room.

Eleven business applications

Every example here is drawn from professional work — not recipes, holidays or party planning.

Think

- Brainstorm positioning options for a tender
- Break an ambiguous problem into decision criteria
- Stress-test a strategy from three stakeholder views
- Explore scenarios before a budget committee
- Plan a phased rollout with dependencies

Write

- Draft a departmental SOP from a described process
- Produce a report section to a defined structure
- Build a reusable template for recurring submissions
- Prepare a presentation narrative
- Draft terms of reference for a working group

Analyse

- Review a document for gaps and inconsistencies
- Compare two vendor proposals against stated criteria
- Summarise a regulatory update into operational impact
- Draft the analysis narrative around validated figures
- Frame the questions a steering committee should ask

SAMPLE PROMPTS

Three prompts you can reuse this week

STRATEGIC CRITIQUE

"You are an experienced operations director. Critique this proposed process change from three perspectives: the frontline team, the finance function and the customer. For each, state the strongest objection and how it could be addressed."

DECISION SUPPORT

"We are choosing between two vendors on cost, implementation risk and support quality. Structure this as a decision matrix, state what evidence each criterion requires, and identify what we have not yet asked either vendor."

SOP DRAFTING

"Convert the process described below into a numbered SOP with responsibilities, inputs, outputs and control points. Flag any step where the description is ambiguous rather than filling the gap yourself."

13

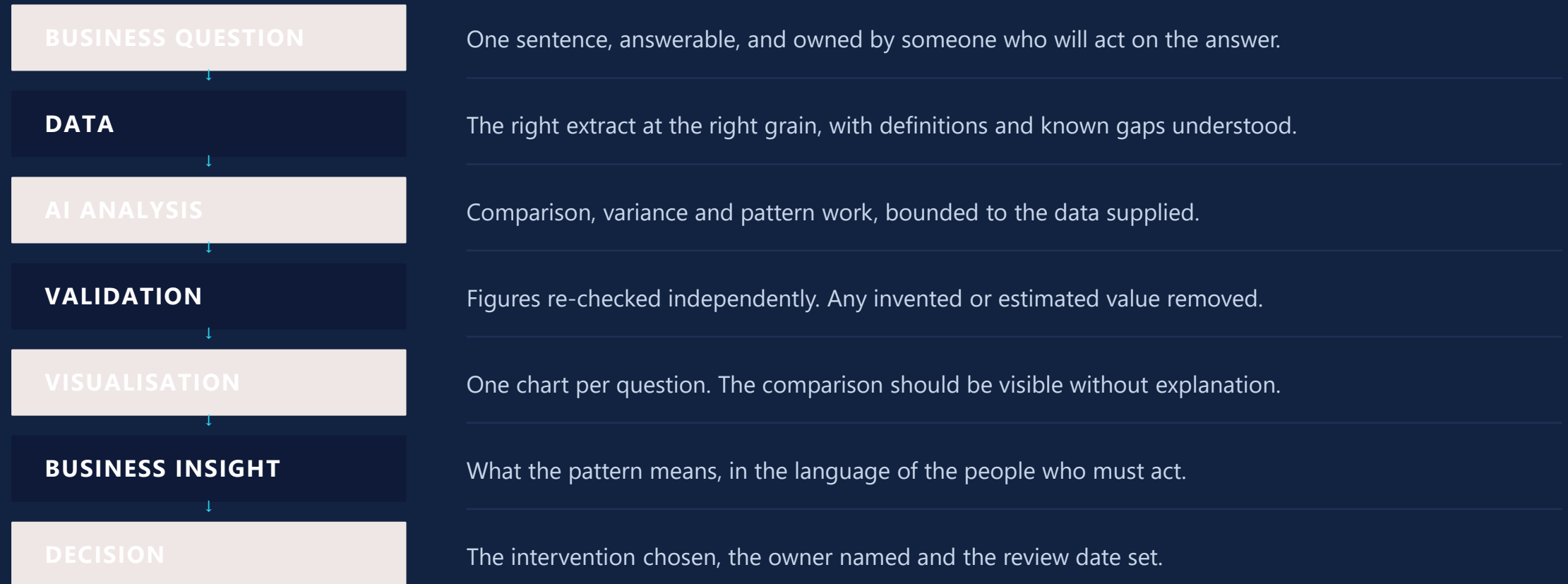
AI for Data Analysis

The seven stages
Domain examples
Validation

A disciplined workflow from business question to decision — with validation built in, not added afterwards.

THE WORKFLOW

Business question to decision, in seven stages



STAGE DISCIPLINE

Where analysis goes wrong — and what fixes it

The two failure points are almost always the first stage and the fourth: no real question, or no independent validation.

AI accelerates the middle of this workflow dramatically. It does nothing for the ends — and the ends are where credibility is won or lost.

NO QUESTION

You get a description of the data instead of an answer. Write the question before the prompt.

WRONG GRAIN

Daily data answered as monthly totals hides exactly the pattern you were looking for.

UNVALIDATED FIGURES

One wrong number in a committee paper costs more credibility than the analysis earns.

NO DECISION

Insight that reaches nobody with authority to act is an expensive hobby.

DOMAIN EXAMPLES

The same workflow across four functions

Function	Business question	What good output looks like
Sales	Why did revenue decline?	Decline decomposed by region, product and month, with the three largest contributors quantified
HR	Which factors appear related to employee turnover?	Candidate factors ranked as hypotheses to test — explicitly not stated as causes
Finance	Where are the largest negative budget variances?	Ranked variance table with value and percentage, plus draft commentary for the review pack
Operations	Which processes are experiencing the longest delays?	Cycle time by stage with the bottleneck named and the outlier cases isolated

14

Asking Better Data Questions

Poor → better → strong
Six worked examples

The quality of an analysis is set before any tool is opened — by the precision of the question.

THE PATTERN

Poor, better, strong — revenue analysis

POOR

No measure, no period, no comparison

"Analyse my data."

BETTER

Measure named, still no benchmark

"Analyse monthly revenue."

STRONG

Period, benchmark, threshold and management framing

"Analyse monthly revenue from January to December. Compare actual versus target, identify the three largest negative variances, highlight unusual patterns and provide three questions management should investigate."

EXAMPLE 2 — WORKFORCE

Asking about employee turnover

POOR

Too broad to answer

"Look at my HR data."

BETTER

Scoped, but no comparison

"Tell me about employee turnover last year."

STRONG

Comparison, threshold and required output

"Using the twelve-month HR extract, calculate turnover by department and tenure band, identify the two groups with the highest rate, compare each against the company average, and list the factors present in the data that warrant investigation. Present findings as hypotheses, not conclusions."

EXAMPLE 3 — BUDGET

Asking about budget variance

POOR

Too broad to answer

"Check my budget file."

BETTER

Scoped, but no comparison

"Show me where we are over budget."

STRONG

Comparison, threshold and required output

"Compare actual against budget by cost centre for the year to date. Rank the ten largest negative variances by value, show each as a percentage of budget, flag any cost centre exceeding 15 per cent overspend, and draft two lines of commentary per flagged item using only the supplied figures."

EXAMPLE 4 — OPERATIONS

Asking about process delays

POOR

Too broad to answer

"Why is everything slow?"

BETTER

Scoped, but no comparison

"Analyse our order processing times."

STRONG

Comparison, threshold and required output

"Using the order records provided, calculate average and median cycle time for each processing stage over the last six months. Identify the stage with the greatest increase, isolate orders exceeding twice the median, and state which stage is the primary bottleneck with the evidence for that conclusion."

EXAMPLE 5 — CUSTOMER

Asking about customer complaints

POOR

Too broad to answer

"Summarise the complaints."

BETTER

Scoped, but no comparison

"What are customers complaining about most?"

STRONG

Comparison, threshold and required output

"Categorise the complaint records into no more than eight themes. For each theme, give the volume, the percentage of total, the trend across the six months, and a representative example. Identify the two themes growing fastest and state what additional data would be needed to explain the growth."

EXAMPLE 6 — INVENTORY

Asking about stock performance

POOR

Too broad to answer

"Look at our stock."

BETTER

Scoped, but no comparison

"Which products are not selling well?"

STRONG

Comparison, threshold and required output

"Using the inventory and sales extract, identify products with more than 90 days of stock cover and declining sales over the last quarter. Rank by value tied up, show cover days and quarterly sales change for each, and recommend three actions with the criteria that should trigger each one."

15

AI for Meetings

Agenda and questions
Minutes and decisions
Follow-up

A routine that makes every meeting produce a record, a decision list and a set of assigned actions.

THE ROUTINE

Seven tasks across the meeting cycle

01 **Preparing agendas**

Time-allocated items each with a stated intended outcome, not a topic label.

02 **Generating discussion questions**

The questions that surface disagreement early rather than after the decision.

03 **Summarising the meeting**

A recap short enough that someone who missed it will actually read it.

04 **Creating minutes**

A consistent format applied every time, produced within the hour.

05 **Extracting decisions**

What was agreed, separated cleanly from what was merely discussed.

06 **Extracting action items**

Owner, action and date — the three fields most minutes leave incomplete.

07 **Preparing follow-up**

The message that goes out before anyone has forgotten what was agreed.

BEFORE AND AFTER

The same meeting, recorded two ways

BEFORE

TYPICAL MINUTES

"The team discussed the delayed implementation. Various options were considered. Finance raised concerns about cost. It was agreed to revisit at the next meeting."

Nothing decided, nobody assigned, nothing verifiable. Three weeks later, no one can reconstruct what happened.

AFTER

STRUCTURED RECORD

Decision: revised go-live date moved to 15 November; approved by the steering committee.

Decision: additional cost of RM48,000 to be funded from the contingency line, subject to Finance confirmation.

Action: Aisyah to issue the revised plan to the vendor by 26 September.

Action: Finance to confirm contingency availability by 24 September.

Open: resourcing for the extended period — not resolved, carried to next meeting.

16

AI for Research

Exploration
Comparison
Verification

Excellent for orientation and structure. Never, on its own, sufficient as evidence.

Eight research tasks worth delegating

Explore

- Frame the research questions worth asking
- Map the landscape of a topic quickly
- Identify the terminology you need to search with
- Surface what you did not know you should ask

Process

- Summarise long documents and reports
- Compare two reports against stated criteria
- Extract findings relevant to your question
- Identify risks and second-order effects

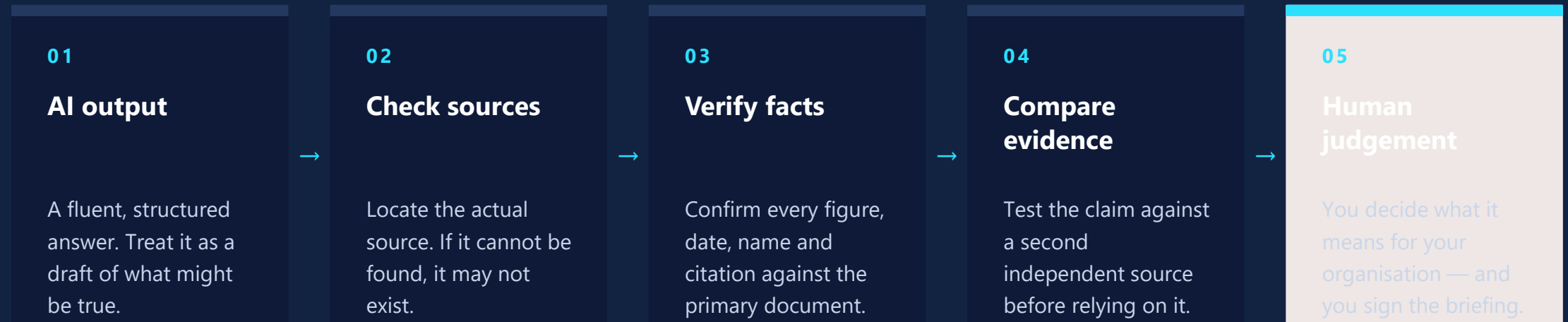
Communicate

- Draft a management briefing
- Structure recommendations with trade-offs
- Separate the established from the uncertain
- Prepare the questions for a specialist

VERIFICATION

AI research ≠ verified research

Output from a model is a starting hypothesis. It becomes evidence only after this sequence.



Citations are the highest-risk element in AI-assisted research. Verify every one before it appears in anything you publish.

ACTIVITY 7

Detect AI hallucination

TIME

20 min

OBJECTIVE

Build the instinct for spotting fabricated detail before it reaches a document.

SCENARIO

You are given a one-page AI-generated briefing on an industry topic. It contains several confident statements, three specific statistics and two named sources. At least two elements are incorrect.

TASK

Working in pairs, identify every claim that requires verification, rank them by risk, and attempt to verify the three statistics. Note which errors were hardest to detect and why.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A marked-up briefing showing verified, unverifiable and incorrect claims — plus one rule you will apply in future.

17

Responsible AI & Data Security

Data classification
Approved platforms
Before you paste
Human verification

The section that determines whether your organisation can scale AI use at all. Read it as policy, not advice.

CLASSIFICATION

Information that requires care before it goes anywhere near a tool

The question is never 'is this useful to paste'. It is 'am I permitted to paste this, here'.

Personal and employee

- Names linked to personal circumstances
- Identification and payroll records
- Performance and disciplinary material
- Health, leave and family information
- Anything covered by data protection law

Commercial and client

- Client names, contracts and pricing
- Unreleased financial results
- Tender and bid material
- Supplier terms and negotiations
- Anything under a non-disclosure agreement

Organisational

- Intellectual property and source material
- Internal strategy and board papers
- Security and infrastructure detail
- Unpublished policies and decisions
- Internal documents marked restricted

THE CONTROL

Before you paste into AI — five questions

If the answer to any of the first three is uncertain, stop and ask before proceeding.

1

Is it confidential?

Check the classification of the document, not your assumption about it.

2

Does it contain personal data?

Names, identifiers, contact details or anything attributable to an individual.

3

Am I authorised to use it?

Permission to read a document is not automatically permission to process it externally.

4

Is the platform approved?

Confirm the specific tool and account type are sanctioned by your organisation.

5

Can I verify the result?

If you cannot check the output, you cannot responsibly use it.

STANDING INSTRUCTION

Do not paste confidential organisational information into an unapproved AI platform.

This applies regardless of how useful the result would be, how quickly it is needed, or who asked. Where a task genuinely requires internal information, use a platform your organisation has approved for that classification of data — and if you are not certain which that is, ask before you proceed rather than afterwards.

PLATFORM CHOICE

Public tools and enterprise environments are not interchangeable

The model may be similar. The governance around it is not.

PUBLIC / CONSUMER AI TOOLS

Treat as an external party

- Data handling governed by the provider's consumer terms
- No organisational access controls or audit trail
- No visibility for your IT or compliance function
- Appropriate only for public or generic material
- Assume anything entered has left your control

APPROVED ENTERPRISE ENVIRONMENTS

Operate within your governance

- Configured under your organisation's agreement
- Existing permissions and access controls apply
- Administrative oversight and policy enforcement
- Suitable for the data classifications your policy permits
- Still requires human verification of all output

ACCOUNTABILITY

Human verification is the final control

No output leaves your hands unchecked. Verification is not a formality at the end — it is the step that makes AI use defensible.

If you cannot explain how the output was produced and confirm that its content is correct, it is not ready to send, publish or present.

VERIFY THE FACTS

Every figure, date, name and citation against the primary source.

VERIFY THE REASONING

Does the conclusion actually follow from the evidence supplied?

VERIFY THE FIT

Is this appropriate for this audience, this relationship and this context?

TAKE OWNERSHIP

Your name is on it. That does not change because a tool produced the draft.

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Practical Business Use Cases

HR · Finance · Operations
Sales · Marketing · Admin
Management · Projects
Service · Analytics

Twelve worked examples across ten functions, each following the same five-step structure from problem to human validation.

HUMAN RESOURCES

Screening a high volume of applications consistently

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Two hundred applications against a role profile, screened inconsistently under time pressure

AI APPROACH

Structured comparison against stated, job-relevant criteria — never an automated decision

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Compare each summary against these five job-relevant criteria. Score each criterion and state the evidence. Do not infer anything not written."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A consistent comparison table with evidence cited for every score

HUMAN VALIDATION

A recruiter reviews every shortlist decision; the tool never rejects a candidate

HUMAN RESOURCES

Turning an engagement survey into management action

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Eight hundred free-text survey comments that nobody has the time to read

AI APPROACH

Thematic categorisation with volume and sentiment per theme

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Group these comments into no more than eight themes. For each: volume, share of total, representative quote, and the sentiment direction."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A themed summary with the three issues raised most often

HUMAN VALIDATION

HR confirms themes against a sample of raw comments before reporting to leadership

Producing the monthly variance commentary

BUSINESS PROBLEM

The variance pack takes two days to write and reads differently every month

AI APPROACH

Draft commentary generated from validated figures using a fixed structure

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Using only this variance table, write two lines of commentary per cost centre with a variance above 10 per cent. State value, percentage and the most likely driver present in the data."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A consistent first-draft commentary covering every flagged line

HUMAN VALIDATION

The finance manager verifies every figure and rewrites any speculative driver

FINANCE

Preparing a budget committee briefing

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A 30-page budget submission that the committee will not read before the meeting

AI APPROACH

Executive summarisation framed around decisions rather than description

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Summarise this submission into one page for a budget committee. Lead with the approvals required, then the three largest changes from last year with figures."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A one-page decision-led brief with approvals stated up front

HUMAN VALIDATION

The submitting manager confirms every figure and the accuracy of each approval request

OPERATIONS

Converting tribal knowledge into an SOP

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A critical process exists only in one experienced person's head

AI APPROACH

Structured conversion of a described process into an auditable procedure

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Convert this description into a numbered SOP with responsibilities, inputs, outputs and control points. Flag any ambiguous step rather than filling the gap."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A draft SOP with the gaps explicitly marked for clarification

HUMAN VALIDATION

The process owner and one operator walk through it before it is approved

OPERATIONS

Identifying the bottleneck in a delayed process

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Orders are consistently late but the responsible stage is disputed

AI APPROACH

Cycle-time analysis by stage with outliers isolated

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Calculate average and median cycle time per stage for six months. Identify the stage with the greatest increase and isolate orders exceeding twice the median."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A ranked stage comparison naming the primary bottleneck with evidence

HUMAN VALIDATION

Operations verifies the timestamps and confirms the data reflects the real process

Preparing for a major account renewal

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A renewal meeting in two days and the account history is spread across threads and files

AI APPROACH

Consolidated account briefing with the risks and open commitments surfaced

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Summarise this account's activity over twelve months. List open commitments, unresolved complaints and every objection previously raised."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A one-page briefing with the likely objections listed in advance

HUMAN VALIDATION

The account manager confirms the commitments against the contract before the meeting

MARKETING

Developing campaign positioning options

BUSINESS PROBLEM

One positioning idea in the room and a deadline that leaves no time for a workshop

AI APPROACH

High-volume ideation, then structured evaluation against agreed criteria

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Generate fifteen positioning angles for this product for this audience. Then evaluate the strongest five against differentiation, credibility and ease of execution."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Fifteen options narrowed to five with reasoning against each criterion

HUMAN VALIDATION

Marketing validates claims against what the product can actually substantiate

ADMINISTRATION

Standardising recurring documentation

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Every department writes the same report in a different format

AI APPROACH

Template generation with a worked example for each section

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Create a standard reporting template for monthly departmental updates. For each section state the purpose, the required content and a one-line worked example."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A reusable template with guidance that reduces review cycles

HUMAN VALIDATION

Two departments pilot the template before it is issued organisation-wide

Stress-testing a proposed decision

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A recommendation is heading to the committee and nobody has argued the other side

AI APPROACH

Structured multi-perspective critique before the decision is tabled

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Critique this proposal from the perspective of finance, the frontline team and the customer. For each, state the strongest objection and how it could be addressed."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Three structured objections with mitigations, ready to be tested internally

HUMAN VALIDATION

The management team judges which objections are real and which are already resolved

Rebuilding a plan after a slipped milestone

BUSINESS PROBLEM

A project is four weeks late and the dependencies have not been reassessed

AI APPROACH

Structured re-planning with risks and decision points made explicit

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Given this plan and a four-week delay at milestone three, identify affected dependencies, propose two recovery options with trade-offs, and list the decisions needed this week."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Two recovery options with the trade-offs and decision points stated

HUMAN VALIDATION

The project manager validates dependencies with each workstream lead

Raising the consistency of written responses

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Response quality varies by agent and complaints escalate unnecessarily

AI APPROACH

Drafting support with a defined tone standard and mandatory elements

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"Draft a response to this complaint that acknowledges the issue, explains the cause without excuses, offers a specific remedy and states the next step. Under 180 words."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A consistent, courteous draft containing every required element

HUMAN VALIDATION

The agent confirms the remedy is authorised before sending — never automatic

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Prompt Library

Email · Reports · Meetings
Excel · Data · Research
Management · Planning

A small set of prompts you genuinely reuse is worth more than a hundred you saved and never opened.

Correspondence and written reporting

PROFESSIONAL REWRITE

"Rewrite this message to be professional and neutral. Under 120 words, no blame, ending with a clear next step and a date."

REPORT SECTION

"Write the [section] of a [report type] for [audience] using only the data below. State performance against target, explain the two largest variances with evidence, and close with three recommended actions. Maximum 400 words."

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

"Create a one-page executive summary of this document in three labelled sections: risks, performance, recommended actions. Use only content contained in the document."

Meetings and presentations

AGENDA

"Create an agenda for a [duration] [meeting type] with [participants]. Allocate time per item, state the intended outcome for each, and include three questions we should be prepared to answer."

MINUTES

"From this transcript, produce two tables: decisions taken, and action items with owner and due date. List separately anything discussed but not decided."

DECK OUTLINE

"Convert this document into a [n]-slide outline for [audience] using Situation, Insight, Implication, Recommendation, Action. Full-sentence takeaway titles, three supporting points of under eight words each."

Analysis and data questions

VARIANCE ANALYSIS

"Compare actual against target by [dimension] for [period]. Rank the largest negative variances, show value and percentage, flag anything beyond [threshold], and draft two lines of commentary per flagged item."

FORMULA SUPPORT

"Explain this formula step by step in plain language and tell me what would break it: [formula]. Then suggest a more robust alternative if one exists."

KPI DESIGN

"Recommend five KPIs for monitoring [process] in a [industry] business. For each, state the definition, the data required and the behaviour it will drive."

Research, planning and problem solving

BRIEFING WITH UNCERTAINTY FLAGGED

"Brief me on [topic] for [audience]. For each point state the practical implication and what remains uncertain. Separate established points from areas you are unsure of, and list what we should verify independently."

DECISION MATRIX

"Structure this choice between [options] against [criteria]. State what evidence each criterion requires and identify what we have not yet asked."

PROBLEM BREAKDOWN

"Break this problem into its components, state the decision criteria that apply, identify what information is missing, and propose the order in which to resolve them."

ACTIVITY 8

Create a reusable prompt template

TIME

20 min

OBJECTIVE

Leave the programme with a prompt you will use repeatedly in your own role.

SCENARIO

Identify one task you perform at least weekly that involves writing, summarising or analysing — the one that consumes the most time for the least judgement.

TASK

Build a template prompt with all six components and bracketed placeholders for what changes each time. Test it twice with different inputs and refine the wording that failed.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

One tested, reusable prompt template saved somewhere you will actually find it again.

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Practical AI Workflow

The ten steps
A complete worked example

Everything from the two days, reduced to ten steps you can follow without referring back to these slides.

THE WORKING METHOD

Ten steps from task to applied result

01 **Define the objective**

What decision or deliverable does this actually need to produce?

02 **Provide context**

The situation, the audience and what has already happened.

03 **Assign the task**

One clear instruction with a precise verb.

04 **Add requirements**

Quantity, coverage and the elements that must appear.

05 **Set constraints**

Sources permitted, length, and what must not be invented.

06 **Specify the output**

Table, list, email, outline — name the container.

07 **Review**

Read it as a draft. Name the specific gap.

08 **Refine**

Add what was missing; keep what already worked.

09 **Validate**

Check every figure, date, name and citation at source.

10 **Apply human judgement**

Decide whether it is right for this audience — then sign it.

COMPLETE WORKED EXAMPLE

One task, start to finish

A quarterly performance summary for a leadership committee, produced in under twenty minutes.

BUSINESS PROBLEM

The leadership committee meets Thursday and the quarterly summary has not been started

AI APPROACH

Draft the narrative around already-validated figures, structured for a decision, not a description

EXAMPLE PROMPT

"You are an operations manager writing for a leadership committee. Using only the Q3 data below, write the executive section: performance against target, the two largest variances with evidence, one emerging risk, three recommended actions. Maximum 400 words, with subheadings."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

A structured draft covering every required element, in the committee's register

HUMAN VALIDATION

Every figure re-checked in the source workbook; the risk assessment rewritten in the manager's own words before circulation

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Seven principles to carry back to work

01 **AI is an assistant, not an authority**

It produces drafts and options. It does not produce decisions.

02 **Better context improves output**

The single largest lever available to you costs thirty seconds.

03 **Prompt quality matters**

Structure consistently outperforms cleverness.

04 **Results must be validated**

Every figure, date, name and citation, at source, every time.

05 **Confidentiality must be protected**

Approved platforms only, and the right classification of data.

06 **Human judgement remains essential**

Nothing in these two days transfers accountability away from you.

07 **AI should augment capability**

Use the time it returns for the work that requires your expertise.

QUICK REFERENCE 1

The prompt formula

Keep this within reach for the first month. After that you will not need it.

1	2	3	4	5	6
ROLE	CONTEXT	TASK	REQUIREMENTS	CONSTRAINTS	OUTPUT
"Act as a senior financial analyst..."	"Our revenue declined in Q2 following..."	"Analyse the data below and explain..."	"Identify the top three drivers, quantified..."	"Use only the data provided. Under 300 words."	"Present as a table with these columns..."

QUICK REFERENCE 2

The AI output checklist

Seven questions between the output and anything you send, publish or present.

1

Accurate?

Every figure, date and name verified at source.

2

Relevant?

It answers the question actually asked.

3

Complete?

Nothing essential to the decision is missing.

4

Supported?

Each claim traces to evidence you can produce.

5

Safe & confidential

No inappropriate disclosure, on an approved platform.

6

Verified & owned?

You have checked it and you stand behind it.

QUICK REFERENCE 3

Copilot or ChatGPT — a scenario guide

If you need to...	Start with	Because
Summarise an internal meeting or thread	Microsoft Copilot	The content is in your tenant and needs permission-aware access
Work on the document or workbook already open	Microsoft Copilot	It operates in place, inside your governed environment
Generate many options or ideas quickly	ChatGPT	Open-ended ideation with no internal data dependency
Critique a plan from several perspectives	ChatGPT	Multi-perspective reasoning on material you choose to share
Analyse internal data inside Microsoft 365	Microsoft Copilot	The data stays within your organisational boundary
Explore an unfamiliar external topic	ChatGPT	Broad exploration — with sources verified independently

In all cases: your organisation's AI and data policy takes precedence.

PERSONAL ACTION PLAN

Before you leave this room, commit to four things

Write them down. An intention that is not written is a conversation you had at a training course.

01 **One task you will automate or improve this week**

Specific, recurring, and starting within the next five working days.

02 **One prompt template you will save and reuse**

The one you built in Activity 8 — stored where you will find it.

03 **One verification habit you will not skip**

The check that protects you when the output is wrong.

04 **One policy question you will ask your organisation**

Which platforms are approved, and for which classification of data.

FINAL DISCUSSION

What will you automate or improve first?

Name the task, not the tool.

State the time it takes you today.

Say what you will do with the time it returns.

QUESTIONS

Q & A

Bring the task you could not make work, the output you did not trust, or the policy question you are still unsure about. If the answer depends on your licence or your administrator's configuration, I will say so rather than guess.

THANK YOU

AI for Modern Work

Boosting Productivity with Microsoft Copilot & ChatGPT

Fakhrul Syahmi
Mufasyah Consultant

21–22 September 2026

Thank you for two days of genuine participation. The tools will keep changing — the method you practised here will not.

Use it well, verify everything, and keep the judgement where it belongs.